THE INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY & PUBLIC HEALTH

Research Ethics for Practitioners

Safeguarding & Ethics · GUIDE · Version 2.1

Guidance on when service evaluation becomes research and how to navigate ethical approval.

Overview

The line between service evaluation and research is often blurred. This guide clarifies the distinction and walks practitioners through proportionate ethical review.

What's inside

A plain-language overview you can read in one sitting
• Step-by-step guidance with decision points called out
• Worked examples drawn from real community practice
• A one-page summary to keep at your desk

How to use it

Read it through once to orient yourself, then return to the relevant section when you need it. Share the one-page summary with colleagues who need the headlines rather than the detail.

About this collection

This document belongs to the Safeguarding & Ethics collection of the ResourceVault library and is provided as a demonstration document for evaluation purposes.